

0.0.1 Simile of the Mountain 3

0. At Savatthi

1. Suppose, O bhikkhus, a man were to place down seven pebbles the size of mung beans near Sineru, the king of mountains. “So what do you think, O bhikkhus, which is more? The seven pebbles the size of mung beans that is placed down or Sineru, the king of mountains?”

2. “This, O Bhante, is clearly more, namely Sineru, the king of mountains. The seven pebbles the size of mung beans that is placed down is insignificant. In comparison with Sineru, they king of mountains, the seven pebbles the size of mung beans that is placed down do not even approach a hundredth part, nor a thousandth part, nor a hundred-thousandth part.”

3. “It is just so, O bhikkhus, for the attainment of the noble disciple, for the one accomplished in view. In comparison to the attainments of the samanas, brahmanas and wanderers of other standpoints, they do not even approach a hundredth part, nor a thousandth part, nor a hundred-thousandth part. So great, O bhikkhus, is the attainment of the one accomplished in view, so great is his supreme knowledge.”